FLOW FUNDER STORIES OF IMPACT (WITH PHOTOS)

Cohort 1 • October, 2024 - Present (Q1, 2026)

Presentation by Sydney Griffith, Kinship Earth Executive Director

ENVIRONMENTAL JUSTICE & WATER PROTECTION

End Recipient:

Water Legacy

Flow Funder: Paula Maccabee

End Recipient Location: Duluth, Minnesota, USA

Amount Deployed: $10,000

Impact Summary:
Paula directed funds to WaterLegacy's legal fight against the Mile Post 7 tailings dam expansion above Lake Superior. Without an Environmental Impact Statement, the risk of catastrophic dam failure threatened nearby communities and Tribal lands. This support enabled appeals, legal briefs, & testimony to press for halting construction until safety / environmental reviews are complete.

Quote:
"This support gave us the courage to ask for what the community really needed - stopping construction until the courts decide and reviews are done." - Paula Maccabee

End Recipient:

East African Coastal Forest Women's Flow Fund

Flow Funder: Faith Flanigan (via Regenerosity)

End Recipient Location: Zanzibar, Mozambique, Kenya, Zimbabwe, Somalia

Amount Deployed: $20,500

Impact Summary:

Faith coordinated a bioregional flow fund supporting 10 women leading regenerative agriculture and food sovereignty initiatives in the East African Coastal Forests, a global biodiversity hotspot. Projects include agroecology, food forests, permaculture training, and community-based forest restoration.

Quote:

"This is our first bioregional Flow Funding effort. The idea is to support these women with their collaborative efforts and their knowledge sharing across the coastal forest bioregion." - Faith Flanigan

INDIGENOUS SOVERIEGNTY

End Recipient:

Timothy Swallow - Lakota Spiritual Leader

Flow Funder: Jessica LaBrie

End Recipient Location: Boston, MA / Pine Ridge, South Dakota, USA

Amount Deployed: $3,000

Impact Summary:
Jessica flowed funds to Timothy, a Lakota chief and spiritual leader, who provides sacred ceremony, cultural education, and political advocacy. The funds bolstered his treaty rights work, youth mentorship, & the fight against addiction and violence on Pine Ridge Reservation.

Quote:
"Timothy is training the next generation of Spiritual Warriors for the Earth." - Jessica LaBrie

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

Xa Kako Dile – Caspar, California

Flow Funder: Adriana Dakin

End Recipient Location: Caspar, California, USA (Pomo Nation)

Amount Deployed: $200

Impact Summary:

Adriana backed Tanda Blubear's campaign to acquire a freeze dryer, ensuring healthy food access for Pomo people year-round. The initiative blends cultural pride with food sovereignty.

Quote:

"We don't come up until we all come up… we need to help each other get where we are going, together." – Tanda Blubear

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

Slim Butte Agricultural Development Program

Flow Funder: The Fountain for Natural Order of Our Existence

End Recipient Location: Oglala Sioux, South Dakota, USA

Amount Deployed: $3,000

Impact Summary:
Flow Funds were used to provide winter heat for Oglala Sioux families during a dangerously cold winter. Matching donations multiplied the impact, ensuring many households had heat.

Quote:
"It was wonderful to have 3 organizations collaborate to make this happen." - Joyti Ma of The Fountain

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

Slim Butte Agricultural Development Program

Flow Funder: The Fountain for Natural Order of Our Existence

End Recipient Location: Oglala Sioux, South Dakota, USA

Amount Deployed: $1,000

Impact Summary:
Funds were pooled to purchase a truck for Slim Butte Agricultural Program, which supports food security and community gardening across Pine Ridge.

Quote:
"3 organizations collaborated to bring good benefit to the many."
- Jyoti Ma of The Fountain

End Recipient:

Pine Ridge Reservation Residents

Flow Funder: Raycen American Horse Raines

End Recipient Location: Pine Ridge, South Dakota, USA

Amount Deployed: $3,000

Impact Summary:

Raycen purchased a freeze dryer to extend the shelf life of local harvests, strengthening food security and self-reliance for Pine Ridge Reservation residents.

Quote:

"This technology extended the shelf life of our harvests and increases food security year round." - Raycen American Horse Raines

FOOD SECURITY & REGENERATIVE AGRICULTURE

End Recipient:

Antyodoy Anath Ashram

Flow Funder: Darren J. Glenn

End Recipient Location: Bhupatinagar, Purba Medinipur, India

Amount Deployed: $500

Impact Summary:

Darren supported an orphanage and community hub serving abandoned children since 1995, directing funds toward youth environmental education and entrepreneurship opportunities.

Quote:

"Solidarity can transcend geographical boundaries… investing in the next generation ensures a sustainable future." - Darren J. Glenn

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

Farming Falmouth

Flow Funder: Kristina Landau

End Recipient Location: Cape Cod, Massachusetts, USA

Amount Deployed: $4,150

Impact Summary:
Kristina supported Farming Falmouth's service garden, which produced over 5,000 lbs of food for low-income families. The funds will also expand composting and seed planting to reach over 6,500 lbs in 2025.

Quote:
"$1,000 of seeds can produce $40,000 worth of food. This support will empower 100+ volunteers to grow and share high-quality food with families in need." - Kristina Landau

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

Abe Collins

Flow Funder: Julie Davenson

End Recipient Location: Rochester, Vermont, USA

Amount Deployed: $1,000

Impact Summary:

Julie directed funds to Abe Collins and the Land Care Cooperative, working to restore watersheds and regenerate soils while strengthening neighborly economics.

Quote:

"For the first time, I feel like a funder values grassroots efforts determined necessary by the community. It is important to fund the people, not only the organizations." - Julie Davenson

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

Jennifer Christian of Farming Falmouth

Flow Funder: Kristina Landau

End Recipient Location: Falmouth, Massachusetts, USA

Amount Deployed: $750

Impact Summary:

Kristina supported Jennifer's permaculture education work, helping launch a chicken farm to teach animal husbandry and community-scale meat processing to families facing food insecurity.

Quote:
"I learned what a huge impact $750 can bring to a farmer serving their local community!" - Kristina Landau

KINSHIP EARTH

DISASTER RELIF & COMMUNITY RESILIENCE

End Recipient:

Danilla Sands – United Disaster Relief of Northern California (UDRNC)

Flow Funder: Adriana Dakin

End Recipient Location: Ukiah, California, USA

Amount Deployed: $100

Impact Summary:

Adriana supported Danilla's crowdfunding campaign to renovate UDRNC's new warehouse. A matching donor doubled contributions, helping this all-volunteer disaster relief org scale its work.

End Recipient:

Beloved Asheville

Flow Funder: Scott Guzman of Permatours

End Recipient Location: Asheville, North Carolina, USA

Amount Deployed: $1,250

Impact Summary:

Permatours flowed funds to Beloved Asheville's disaster recovery efforts, providing food, clothing, water, hygiene kits, and building supplies to those impacted by Hurricane Helene.

Quote:

"Large amounts of donations flood in right after disasters, but ongoing support during rebuilding is critical. We're grateful we could support those struggling post Hurrican Helene in this way." - Scott Guzman

KINSHIP EARTH

WOMEN, YOUTH, & EDUCATION

End Recipient:

Stephanie Edwards

Flow Funder: Adriana Dakin

End Recipient Location: Tennessee, USA, & Kenya

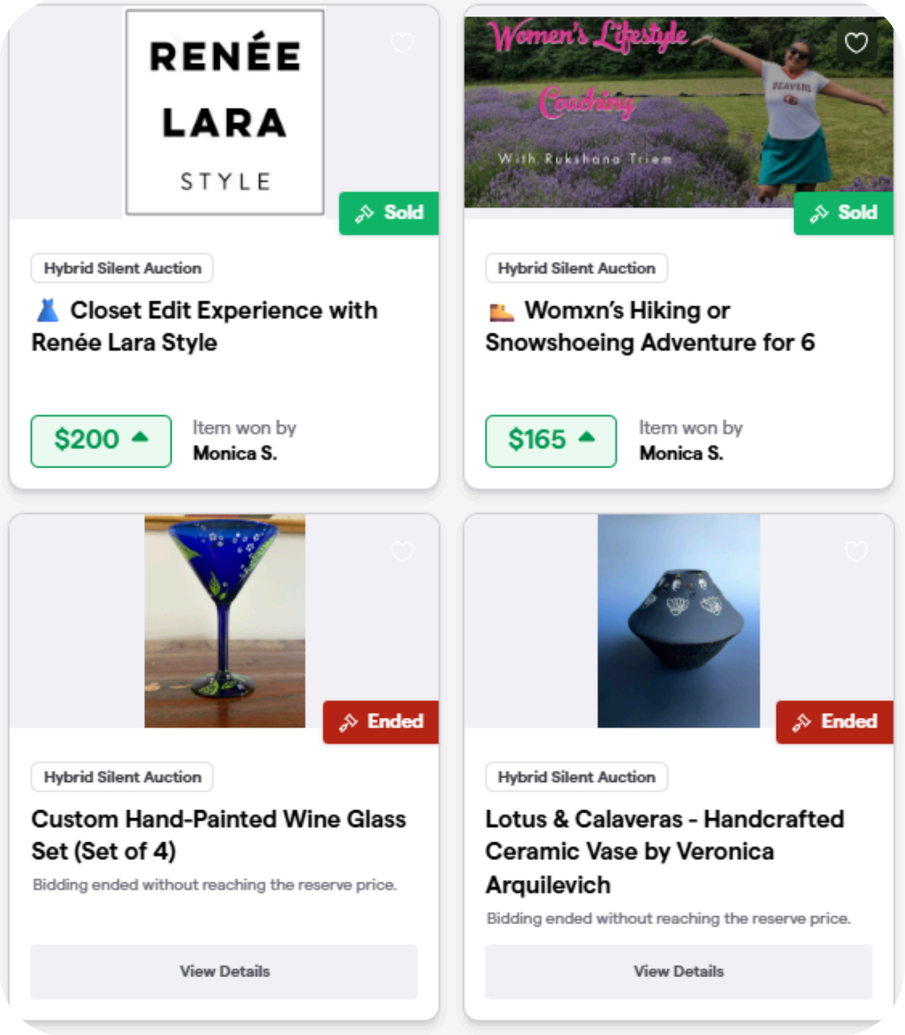
Amount Deployed: $200

Impact Summary:

Adriana boosted Jubilee's launch campaign, which provides employment for women leaving foster care in the U.S. and artisans in Kenya. The funds covered one week's wages for a woman artisan.

Quote:

"It's fantastic being able to reward courage in fundraising - where almost everyone fears rejection." - Adriana Dakin



KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

The Real Wings, Inc.

Flow Funder: Adriana Dakin

End Recipient Location: Baltimore, Maryland, USA

Amount Deployed: $200

Impact Summary:

Adriana supported elder Janice Bryant-Baker and her nonprofit mentoring teens through community projects and cultural experiences. Funds covered a field trip to NYC, broadening horizons for youth.

Quote:

"Janice gives so much - it was an honor to help her fundraise and step into asking for support." - Adriana Dakin

End Recipient:

Colorful Minds

Flow Funder: Adriana Dakin

End Recipient Location: San Francisco Bay Area, California, USA

Amount Deployed: $200

Impact Summary:

Adriana supported Colorful Minds' campaigns, which empower artisans with disabilities worldwide. Funds gave momentum to their charity walk and anniversary campaign.

End Recipient:

Imene Ghernati

Flow Funder: Adriana Dakin

End Recipient Location: Burlingame, California, USA

Amount Deployed: $700

Impact Summary:

Adriana backed Imene's liberatory STEAM workshops, which increase DEIB in classrooms and provide stipends to under-resourced educators.

Quote:

"Imene has taught me so much about the value of paying hardworking, under-resourced changemakers so they can commit fully to the work."
- Adriana Dakin

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

David Davenport

Flow Funder: Adriana Dakin

End Recipient Location: Chicago, Illinois, USA

Amount Deployed: $50

Impact Summary:
Adriana supported David, a longtime Southside activist launching programs for women survivors of trafficking to learn AI & STEM skills. He also works with youth, police, and communities on kitchen training and civic health.

Quote:
"David is shifting the narrative for our country with wisdom and fire." – Adriana Dakin

KINSHIP EARTH

FOOD SECURITY & CROSS-CULTURAL EXCHANGE

End Recipient:

Tumianuma Women's Gardens

Flow Funder: Walter Moora

End Recipient Location: Loja Province, Ecuador

Amount Deployed: $1,986

Impact Summary:

Walter funded women-led gardens in Ecuador, strengthening food systems and cultural exchange. He also joined in the fieldwork, deepening relationships between local women and international allies.

Quote:

"Most of the women did not have the opportunity for higher education, yet they are incredibly intelligent and hungry for knowledge. These funds built relationships as well as gardens." - Walter Moora

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

Aguas Community Project

Flow Funder: Patrick Collins (“Pato”)

End Recipient Location: Aguas, Puntarenas, Costa Rica

Amount Deployed: $7,953

Impact Summary:
This grant supported regenerative initiatives in the Aguas community, focusing on ecological restoration, sustainable livelihoods, and infrastructure for community well-being. This funding reinforced cross-regional collaboration, modeling how trust-based funding can strengthen ecological and cultural resilience in Costa Rica.

Quote:
"This experience reinforced the value of bioregional flow funding - how trust-based disbursement can activate community capacity and deepen cross-regional collaboration."- Patrick Collins

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

Verdenergia (Costa Rica)

Flow Funder: Patrick Collins (“Pato”)

End Recipient Location: Lanas De Puriscal, San Jose, Costa Rica

Amount Deployed: $5,447

Impact Summary:
Funds provided seeds, tools, and cacao processing equipment for a cooperative of local regenerative farmers in Lanas de Puriscal. The aim was to build independent livelihoods, increase food sovereignty, and establish sustainable income through organic farming and value-added forest products

Quote:
"I learned that that the investment of energy and time as a flow funder in order to do it in a readlly good way is quite the offering in itself"
- Patrick Collins

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

Water Legacy, St. Louis River Alliance, & Three Waters Pipeline

Flow Funder: Jacklyn Janeksela

End Recipient Location: Duluth & Minneapolis, Minnesota, USA

Amount Deployed: $3,000 to each entity (total $9,000)

Impact Summary:

Jacklyn directed funds to 3 Minnesota-based environmental orgs protecting regional waterways & opposing extractive pipeline development. Drawing on her connection to the land and people of her home region, she engaged in dialogue with each group to determine how funds could best strengthen grassroots water protection & community organizing efforts across the St. Louis River watershed.

Quote:

"How vital it is to be in authentic conversation with each other and the land; the reason we are here is to not only be good stewards of what we've been given, but also to be exemplary children of Earth Mother so the younger generation, who are watching us, have a solid idea of how to be a deeply feeling and generous adult. I learned to trust my intuition, the waters, and my heart that aches to be in right relationship with all entities." – Jacklyn Janeksela

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

Regenerate Cascadia, a program of the Department of Bioregion

Flow Funder: Brandon Letsinger via Regenerate Cascadia

End Recipient Location: Cascadia Bioregion

Amount Deployed: $15,000

Impact Summary:
$15,000 supported the design and implementation of the Bioregional Flow Funding model via the Landscape Hub Cultivator program. This successfully attracted over $60,000 in matching funds, strengthening local capacity and collaboration across nine Landscape Groups. The concept of bioregional financing was publicly shared in a book and at the first Bioregional Finance Conference

Quote:
"Through this experience, I learned how powerful it can be to design funding systems that trust communities to lead their own regeneration."
- Brandon Letsinger

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

Place-based media network via Bloom Network

Flow Funder: Magenta Ceiba via Bloom Network

End Recipient Location: 30 local hubs in 11 countries

Amount Deployed: $18,660

Impact Summary:
Funds were flowed retroactively to ten grassroots projects globally, supporting local infrastructure (e.g., greenhouses), agroforestry, and economic empowerment. This approach amplifies local capital flows by intentionally connecting financial resources with community spiritual and material capital

Quote:
"Our intentions around financial flow, trust-building, and relationship weaving come from a similar place as the intention and feminine wisdom of Flow Funding." - Magenta Ceiba

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

Diamante Bridge Collective

Flow Funder: Bloom Network

End Recipient Location: Diamante Valley, Costa Rica

Amount Deployed: $6,969.38

Impact Summary:
Funds were used for various regenerative activities including watershed protection, indigenous solidarity, establishing a Waldorf school, community recycling, economic empowerment, agroforestry, and environmental restoration.

Quote:
"With the support of Flow Funds, more people are participating, feeling seen and honored for their contributions, & there is a greater feeling of global support for what is often difficult, under-resourced work."
- Diamente Bridge Collective member

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

Broadfield Enterprises, Uganda

Flow Funder: Bloom Network

End Recipient Location: Jinja, Uganda

Amount Deployed: $1,158.52

Impact Summary:
This organization focuses on permaculture agroforestry and economic empowerment across 5,000 farmers and over 100,000 school children. They scale a Permaculture School Enterprise model where coffee is grown and sold, with profits returning directly to the schools

Quote:
"The Flow Funds enabled education to kids on permaculture. The kids then planted organic permaculture gardens at home with their families."
- Broadfield Enterprises member

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

Tribes and Natures Defenders Inc.

Flow Funder: Bloom Network

End Recipient Location: Mindanao, Philippines

Amount Deployed: $1,496.97

Impact Summary:
The funding supported the group's work in protecting ancestral tribal cultural practices, increasing tribal food security through agroforestry, reforestation, and biodiversity protection. Specifically, the funds were used to pay women in their community to plant 'power trees'..."

Quote:
Tribal Chief Datu Lanelio Sangcoan expressed that Flow Funds supported their communiy to share their wisdom and practices with the world, to protect Mother Earth for the benefit of all.

https://bloomnetwork.earth/mindanao

End Recipient:

Maybloom Collective

Flow Funder: Bloom Network

End Recipient Location: Eugene, Oregon, United States

Amount Deployed: $1,509.39

Impact Summary:
Building a community education center and demonstration site where people learn about permaculture, gardening, and self-care. Their activities included building a greenhouse and irrigation system, composting food scraps to prevent them from becoming methane, creating over 70 gallons of biochar.

Quote:
"reforestation, carbon sequestration, and community healing needs to happen everywhere whether it's on private or community-owned land" - member of Maybloom Collective

End Recipient:

Muda Outras Economias

Flow Funder: Bloom Network

End Recipient Location: Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

Amount Deployed: $1,281.74

Impact Summary:

Muda Outras Economias created a local community currency called Muda (meaning "change" or "transformation"). The currency rewards participation in local regenerative activities like beach cleanups, supports Black-owned businesses, environmental work, and food security efforts. The impact reports shared by this community highlight stories of community repair, healing, food distribution practices.

End Recipient:

Yusuf Offia Foundation (YOF) Orinte Ezza Elders

Flow Funder: Jyoti Ma - Jeneane Prevatt

End Recipient Location: Ebonyi State, Nigeria (12 villages)

Amount Deployed: $8,400

Impact Summary:

Funds implemented the Food Sovereignty Project in 12 Nigerian villages, focusing on agricultural self-determination, health, and restoring resilience using bio-eco-friendly practices. The work yielded a bountiful harvest in Phase 1, inspiring the community and developing a model intended for replication across 136 agrarian communities

Quote:

"The food sovereignty program is inspiring the community... and planting hope for their original culture." - Jyoti Ma

End Recipient:

Jacob's Bridge to Learning, Inc

Flow Funder: Lester Shaw

End Recipient Location: Tulsa, Oklahoma, USA

Amount Deployed: $5,000

Impact Summary:

The funds supported the Center for Autism after it lost a significant portion of funding. The support allowed the center to continue its critical impact on children's lives, including Shaw's own grandchildren diagnosed with autism.

Quote:

"I learned that meaningful giving isn't just about charity, it's about connection, empathy, and helping others continue their mission when they need it most." - Lester Shaw

https://www.jacobsbridgetolearning.org/

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

HoopDads, Inc.

Flow Funder: Lester Shaw

End Recipient Location: Tulsa, Oklahoma, USA

Amount Deployed: $5,000

Impact Summary:
The organization focuses on fatherhood development by mentoring younger dads and fathers-to-be, strengthening families and community. As an outcome of the program, young men are showing greater interest in their children at school and actively supporting them.

Quote:
"From this experience, I learned the importance of community, mentorship, and shared purpose. Supporting HoopDads showed me that fatherhood is not something to navigate alone, it thrives in a network of encouragement and accountability." - Lester Shaw

End Recipient:

VickyB's Dance Co.

Flow Funder: Lester Shaw

End Recipient Location: Tulsa, Oklahoma, USA

Amount Deployed: $1,000

Impact Summary:
It provides technical dance training, confidence, and mentorship to young Black girls, helping them gain confidence in historically underrepresented spaces. The program helps shape a young person's sense of possibility by providing access and encouragement.

Quote:
"Watching these girls gain confidence and pride through dance showed me that access and encouragement can change the way they see themselves and their future" - Lester Shaw

KINSHIP EARTH

End Recipient:

Muscogee Creek Nation Head Start

Flow Funder: Lester Shaw

End Recipient Location: Glenpool, Oklahoma, USA

Amount Deployed: $2,000

Impact Summary:
Shaw supported this program, which was his first teaching job, to ensure children receive a strong foundation for learning despite limited funding. Flow Funds provided children with resources crucial for early childhood education, which is vital in shaping a child's future.

Quote:
"From supporting Muskogee Creek Head Start, I learned how vital early childhood education is in shaping a child's future. Seeing how much of a difference the right resources can make reminded me that every child deserves a strong start, no matter their circumstances." - Lester Shaw

ARTS, CULTURE, & MEDIA

End Recipient:

BOANA

Flow Funder: Adriana Dakin

End Recipient Location: Ariège, France & Patagonia, Argentina

Amount Deployed: $200

Impact Summary:

Adriana supported BOANA's youth magazine project in Patagonia, led by Eva Bezit, making environmental education accessible in public spaces.

Quote:

"Eva is a fantastic social impact leader. This gift encouraged her to raise the funds needed for a new magazine edition." - Adriana Dakin

End Recipient:

Center for Excellence in Nonprofits (CEN)

Flow Funder: Adriana Dakin

End Recipient Location: Redwood City, California, USA

Amount Deployed: $1,000

Impact Summary:
Adriana backed CEN's leadership development work with 1,000 nonprofits across California. Funds supported workshops and resources for nonprofit leaders, led by Executive Director Shana Peete.

Quote:
"Collaboration in which we can give money to support their cause opens doors and possibilities." - Adriana Dakin

End Recipient:

RCF Connects

Flow Funder: Adriana Dakin

End Recipient Location: Richmond, California, USA

Amount Deployed: $100

Impact Summary:

Adriana flowed funds to RCF Connects, which works toward an equitable society where all communities can thrive. They focus on community-driven solutions, building shared power, and fostering inclusion and belonging, while shifting philanthropy from traditional to transformational approaches.

Quote:

"Even small amounts of funding encourage nonprofits to keep doing the work." - Adriana Dakin